

I. Indian Geography

General Introduction

i. Area

*India is the seventh-largest country in terms of area after **Russia, Canada, USA, China, Brazil and Australia** respectively. India has 28 states and 8 Union territories. Its total area is about 3287263 sq. km. which is approximately 2.4% of the world's total land surface.



*According to the census 2011, 17.5% of the world's population lives in India. The latitudinal and longitudinal extent of India is roughly about 30 degrees, whereas the actual distance measured from the north to south extremity is 3214 km and that from east to west is 2933 km. *As per the census of 2001, there were 6,38,588 villages in India, but after the 2011 census, the number rose to 6,40,932. India's territorial limit extends towards the sea up to **12 nautical miles** (about 22.2 km) from the baseline.

1. With reference to India, which of the following statements (s) is/are correct?

1. India is the sixth largest country of the world.
2. India occupies about 2.4% of the total area of the world.
3. Tropic of Cancer passes through the middle of the country, dividing it into two latitudinal halves.
4. India lies completely in tropic zone.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

Code :

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| (a) 2 and 4 | (b) 1 and 2 |
| (c) 2 and 3 | (d) 3 and 4 |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

Area-wise, India (3.28 million sq. km) is the seventh largest country in the world. India's total area accounts for about 2.4 percent of the total geographical area of the world. Lying entirely in the Northern Hemisphere the mainland lies between latitudes 8°04'N and 37°6'N and longitudes 68°7'E and 97°25'E. The Tropic of Cancer (23°30'N) divides the country into almost two equal parts; thus, one part lies in the tropical zone while other in sub-tropical zone.

2. Which of the following statements are true about India?

Use the code given below to select the correct answer:

1. India is the fifth largest country in the world.
2. It occupies about 2.4 percent of the total area of the lithosphere.
3. Whole of India lies in the torrid zone.
4. 82°30' East Meridian and hemisphere is used to determine Indian Standard Time.

Code :

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 | (b) 2 and 3 |
| (c) 1 and 3 | (d) 2 and 4 |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (d)

India is the seventh largest country after Russia, Canada, USA, China, Brazil and Australia respectively by area and the first largest (state of the World Population report, 2023) by population. It occupies about 2.4 percent of the total area of the land surface. The mainland of India extends between 8°4' North to 37°6' North latitudes, while the tropical zone is stretched between 23°30' North and South latitudes. Therefore statements 1 and 3 is incorrect. The latitudinal extension of the whole of India (including Andaman & Nicobar Islands) lies between 6°45' to 37°6' North latitudes. 82°30' East longitude is used to determine Indian Standard Time.

3. Where does India rank in the area among the countries of the world?

- | | |
|-------------|------------|
| (a) Fifth | (b) Sixth |
| (c) Seventh | (d) Eighth |

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.